



DEPARTMENT OF THE NAVY
NAVAL RESEARCH LABORATORY
4555 OVERLOOK AVE SW
WASHINGTON, DC 20375-5320

Purchase Request No.: 1301341370
J&A No.: 13.501-26-KN08
Estimated Cost: \$639,079

Justification for Other than Full and Open Competition Under Simplified Procedures For Certain Commercial Items In Accordance With Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 13.5

On the basis of the following, I, as the Contracting Officer, hereby approve the use of a sole source proposed contractual action pursuant to the authority of: ☒ 41 U.S.C. 1901 ☐ 41 U.S.C. 1903

- 1. The Naval Research Laboratory Contracting Division proposes to enter into a sole source contract with Elsevier under simplified procedures for certain commercial items included in FAR subpart 13.5.**
- 2. The nature and/or description of the action being approved: sole source under procedures for certain commercial items in accordance with FAR 13.5.**

This Justification and Approval (J&A) authorizes and approves Elsevier's Knovel 35 subscription package. The resulting contract will be Firm Fixed Price using Simplified Acquisition Procedure (SAP).

- 3. A description of the supplies and/or services required, including the delivery schedule and/or the period of performance (inclusive of all option periods), and the estimated dollar value of the acquisition.**

The purpose of this contract is to provide access to licensed information content on the Knovel platform, which provides a comprehensive and essential resource for our engineers and technical staff. Knovel is a web-based application that integrates technical information with analytical and search tools, making it a critical resource for engineers and applied scientists.

The contract will be for a period of 5 years (Base + 4 Options). Each Period of Performance (POP) will be for 12 months (to coincide with 12 month subscription) and will be fully funded for the Base Year.

It is estimated that subscription cost will be \$639,079 for a 5-year period.

	FY26 (BY)	FY27 (OY1)	FY28 (OY2)	FY29 (OY3)	FY30 (OY4)	TOTAL
O&M						\$639,079

- 4. The statutory authority permitting sole source.**

The authority for permitting other than full and open competition is 41 U.S.C. 1901(e)(2), implemented by FAR 13.501(a).

☒ 41 U.S.C. 1901 ☐ 41 U.S.C. 1903

5. A statement demonstrating the unique qualifications of the proposed contractor or the nature of the action requiring use of the authority.

Elsevier is uniquely qualified to provide the required service as it is the sole developer, owner, and distributor of the Knovel platform. The nature of this requirement is for a specialized, integrated database of technical and engineering content coupled with interactive analytical tools, which is a proprietary service available only from this contractor.

This service provides a specialized and integrated database of technical and engineering content coupled with interactive analytical tools that are exclusively available from this contractor. Elsevier maintains exclusive licensing and aggregation rights for a vast collection of resources from nearly 170 leading technical societies and publishers, presenting this curated content within a single, unified platform that cannot be replicated by any other vendor.

Furthermore, the nature of the Knovel platform is inherently unique due to its patented interactive tools, which allow engineers to work directly with technical data through interactive equations, graphs, and material property databases. This combination of a comprehensive, curated content library with powerful, built-in analytical capabilities is a proprietary feature of Elsevier's service. As there are no authorized resellers or alternative platforms that provide this specific integrated solution, Elsevier is the only contractor capable of meeting the agency's requirement, making the use of sole-source authority necessary.

6. A description of efforts made to ensure offers/quotes are solicited from as many potential sources as is practicable, including whether a notice was or will be publicized in the Government Point of Entry (GPE) (as required by FAR 5.2) and, if not, which exception under 5.202 applies.

A Sources Sought Notice was posted to SAM.gov notifying Industry of the Government's intent to sole source this effort to Elsevier. The aforementioned notice was posted for 14 days, from the period of 17 MAR 2026 to 31 MAR 2026. No responses from Industry were received. The Sources Sought Notice was utilized to assess whether there are vendors with the necessary capabilities to meet the Government's requirement. This is the renewal of subscription, following the previous Purchase Order N0017323P1844, which was also sole source to Elsevier. These are intellectual property rights which can only be provided by Elsevier. No other vendors could provide the license for the Knovel platform.

7. The anticipated dollar value of the proposed acquisition, including options if applicable, and a determination by the contracting officer that the anticipated cost to the government will be fair and reasonable.

The anticipated cost to the government for this action is \$639,079. However, the Contracting Officer will determine through price analysis that the proposed price fair and reasonable to the Government in accordance with the method(s) detailed at FAR 13.106-3(a).

8. A description of the market research conducted and the results or the reason market research was not conducted.

Market research and the results thereof are described in detail in Section 6 above.

9. Any other facts supporting the use of sole source.

Not applicable. No other supporting information outside what is listed herein was utilized to support this J&A.

10. A listing of the sources, if any, that expressed, in writing, an interest in the acquisition.

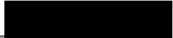
No other sources expressed interest, in writing, for this acquisition.

11. A statement of any actions the agency will take to remove or overcome any future barriers to competition before any subsequent acquisition for the supplies or services required.

Prior to any subsequent acquisition, the NRL commits to overcoming barriers to competition by conducting continuous market research. Our library staff will actively survey the information marketplace, analyze the evolving needs of our scientists and engineers, and engage with industry to identify new vendors or alternative solutions. Should these ongoing research efforts reveal a viable source capable of providing a functionally equivalent integrated platform, the agency will compete the future requirement. Until such a source emerges, the proprietary nature of the Knovel platform remains the primary barrier to competition, and we will continue to assess the feasibility of competition for all future requirements.

CERTIFICATION AND APPROVAL**TECHNICAL/REQUIREMENTS CERTIFICATION**

I certify that the facts and representations under my cognizance, which are included in this Justification and its supporting acquisition planning documents, except as noted herein, are complete and accurate to the best of my knowledge and belief.

_____
Date

Telephone No.**LEGAL SUFFICIENCY REVIEW**

I have determined that this Justification is legally sufficient.

_____
Legal Counsel, Code 1008_____
Date_____
Telephone No.**CONTRACTING OFFICER CERTIFICATION**

I certify that this Justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

_____
Date

Telephone No.